## First in the World – Woman

| First woman | Name | Country |
|---|---|---|
| Prime Minister | Sirimavo Bandaranaike | Sri Lanka |
| In space | Valentina Tereshkova | USSR |
| To scale Mt Everest | Junko Tabei | Japan |
| To win the Olympic gold | Charlotte Cooper | England |

| First in India - Woman |
|---|
| First Women's University Maharshi Karve starts SNDT University in Pune with five students in 1916. |
| First Women to hold a Union Cabinet post Vijaya Lakshmi Pandit |
| First Women to hold a Union Foreign Minister's post Sushma Swaraj (2014) |
| First Women youngest minister of a state Sushma Swaraj (She became the cabinet minister of Haryana when she was only 25 yrs old) |
| First Women governor of Independent India Sarojini Naidu, in charge of United Provinces |
| First Women president of UN General AssemblyVijaya Lakshmi Pandit (1953) |
| First Women Prime Minister of India Indira Gandhi (1966) |
| First Women IPS Officer of India Kiran Bedi (1972) |
| First Women to win Nobel Peace Prize Mother Teresa (1979) |
| First Indian Women to climb Mount Everest Bachendri Pal (1984) |
| First Indian Women to win Booker Prize Arundhati Roy (1997) |
| First Women President Pratibha Patil (2007) |
| First Women Speaker of LokSabha Meira Kumar (2009) |
| First Women judge in Supreme Court Meera Sahib Fatima Bibi |
| First Women President of the Indian National Congress Annie Besant |
| First Women Chief Minister of an Indian State Sucheta Kripalani |
| First Women Director General of Police (DGP) Kanchan Chaudhary Bhattacharya |
| First women defencse Minister of India Nirmala Sitharaman |
| First woman Finance Minister of India Nirmala Sitharaman |

## Factors Responsible for Poor Female Literacy Rate

1. Gender based inequality.
2. Social discrimination and economic exploitation.
3. Occupation of girl child in domestic chores.
4. Low enrolment of girls in schools.
5. Low retention rate and high dropout rate.

## Male Female literacy rate in India: 1951-2011

| Census year | Persons | Males | Females | Male-Female gap in literacy rate |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| 1951 | 18.33 | 27.16 | 8.86 | 18.30 |
| 1961 | 28.3 | 40.4 | 15.35 | 25.05 |
| 1971 | 34.45 | 45.96 | 21.97 | 23.98 |
| 1981 | 43.57 | 56.38 | 29.76 | 26.62 |
| 1991 | 52.21 | 64.13 | 39.29 | 24.84 |
| 2001 | 64.83 | 75.26 | 53.67 | 21.59 |
| 2011 | 74.04 | 82.14 | 65.46 | 16.68 |



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